

Business Requirements Document (BRD): Internal HR Leave Management System

1. Executive Summary

This document outlines the requirements for developing an internal Leave Management System (LMS) to automate the current manual leave application and tracking process at Atlysbridge Solutions. The project aims to transition from inefficient paper-based and spreadsheet-reliant methods to a streamlined, centralized digital platform. The primary goals are to enhance operational efficiency, ensure policy compliance, and provide transparent, real-time leave balance information to all employees. Expected outcomes include a **60% reduction in HR workload** related to leave management, a decrease in the **average leave approval cycle time from 2.5 days to under 8 hours**, and an improved employee experience.

2. Business Objectives

The project is being undertaken to align the company's HR processes with organizational goals for efficiency and data accuracy. The key business objectives are:

- **Operational Efficiency:** Reduce the manual processing time for leave requests by **60%** (from 2.5 days to < 8 hours) for HR and managers, to be achieved **within 90 days** post-deployment.
- **Data Integrity & Payroll Accuracy:** Achieve a **100% accuracy rate** in automated leave balance tracking and subsequent **payroll adjustments** related to leave, measured quarterly, aiming for **zero payroll errors** caused by leave data discrepancy.
- **Employee Adoption & Satisfaction:** Achieve an **employee adoption rate of 95%** within the first month of launch and maintain an average employee satisfaction score of **4.2 out of 5** for the system in the post-implementation survey.
- **Regulatory Compliance:** Ensure the system automatically enforces and maintains full compliance with **all local and national labor laws** (including carry-over and minimum entitlement rules) with **zero compliance breaches** recorded annually.

3. Scope

In-Scope

- Design and implementation of a centralized, web-based portal for all employees, managers, and HR administrators.
- Leave request submission, modification, and cancellation features.
- Automated, multi-level approval workflows based on the defined organizational hierarchy.
- Real-time calculation and display of leave accruals and balances for multiple leave types (e.g., Vacation, Sick, Personal).
- Automated email notifications for all stages of the workflow (submission, approval, rejection, cancellation).
- HR reporting capabilities, including historical usage reports and department summaries.
- Integration with the internal HRIS for importing employee master data (names, IDs, manager hierarchy) via a nightly batch file.

Out-of-Scope (Phase 1)

- Direct, real-time integration with the external third-party payroll vendor. Only batch file export capabilities are in-scope.
- Development of a dedicated mobile application (web responsiveness is in-scope).
- Complex time-sheeting features beyond simple full-day or half-day leave tracking.
- Integration with other HR systems (e.g., Performance Management, Benefits enrollment).
- Any non-essential features, such as custom dashboard themes or gamification.

4. Stakeholders and Responsibilities

Stakeholder Group	Role in Project	Key Responsibility
Project Sponsor (HR Head)	Overall Accountability	Final sign-off on policy configuration and system acceptance.

Steering Committee (Senior Management, CFO)	Governance & Funding	Quarterly budget review and strategic alignment approval.
System Owners (HR Department)	Policy & Administration	Configure and manage leave policies quarterly; Perform user training.
Approvers (Department Managers and Team Leads)	Operational Use	Approve or reject all pending requests within 48 business hours.
End Users (All Employees)	System Use	Submit all leave requests and track personal balances; Provide post-implementation feedback.
Project Team (PM, IT Dev, QA)	Delivery & Maintenance	Deliver the system per BRD specification; Provide post-launch support.

5. Current Process

Currently, Atlysbridge Solutions manages employee leave through a manual, three-step process:

1. **Request:** An employee submits a leave request via email or a physical paper form.
2. **Review:** The manager manually reviews the request, checks the employee's remaining balance (often by cross-referencing a shared spreadsheet), and approves or rejects it.
3. **Record:** HR staff manually updates the central master leave tracking spreadsheet and sends a final confirmation email.

Pain Points of the Current Process

- **Manual Errors:** "The error rate in manual data entry for payroll adjustments is approximately **3%** per pay cycle, leading to frequent reconciliation issues."
- **Delays:** "Average request approval time is **2.5 business days**, causing planning issues for both employees and managers."

- **Administrative Burden:** "HR staff spend an average of **15 hours per week** on routine leave request processing and balance inquiries, distracting them from strategic tasks."
- **Reporting Difficulty:** "Generating accurate historical or audit reports is time-consuming and prone to aggregation errors."
- **Lack of Visibility:** "Employees and managers lack real-time visibility into current balances, leading to frequent inquiries to HR."

6. Proposed Solution

The proposed solution is a centralized Leave Management System (LMS) that will serve as the single source of truth for all employee leave data. The system automates the entire leave request lifecycle, eliminating manual spreadsheet management and minimizing HR intervention.

Benefits by Stakeholder Group:

- **Employees (End Users):** Self-service 24/7 access to real-time balances and policy details; faster approval times.
- **Managers (Approvers):** Instant visibility into team schedules and balances; automated policy adherence, minimizing approval risk.
- **HR Department (System Owners):** 60% reduction in administrative workload; centralized policy configuration; rapid, accurate reporting.
- **Payroll:** Standardized data export format for leave usage, resulting in near-zero payroll adjustment errors.
- **Senior Management:** Guaranteed compliance with labor laws; strategic data on workforce utilization and accrued liability.

7. Requirements

7.1 Business Requirements

The following requirements define what the business needs the system to achieve:

- **BR-1 (Submission):** Employees must be able to submit, modify, and cancel planned leave requests online, accessible 24/7.
- **BR-2 (Balance Accuracy):** The system must automatically calculate and display an employee's accrued, utilized, and remaining leave balance, updated within 1 hour of any transaction (submission, approval, cancellation).

- **BR-3 (Notification Speed):** The system must send an automated email notification to the manager and employee when a request is submitted, approved, or rejected, with a guaranteed delivery time of under 5 minutes.
- **BR-4 (Reporting Efficiency):** HR administrators must be able to generate audit reports detailing all leave transactions for a specific employee or department over a selectable date range, completing the query execution within 30 seconds.
- **BR-5 (Policy Enforcement):** The system must enforce defined company policy limits, such as requiring specific supporting documentation for certain leave types (e.g., sick leave after 3 consecutive days).
- **BR-6 (Manager Visibility):** Managers must be able to view their direct reports' historical leave usage and future planned leave on a single dashboard before approving a new request.
- **BR-7 (Leave Types):** The system must support and differentiate between at least five distinct, configurable leave types (e.g., Vacation, Sick, Personal, Maternity/Paternity, Bereavement).
- **BR-8 (Negative Balance Prevention):** The system must prevent employees from submitting leave requests that would result in a negative balance unless explicitly overridden by an authorized HR administrator.
- **BR-9 (Compliance):** The system must comply with all national labor laws regarding minimum leave entitlements and maximum continuous leave duration.
- **BR-10 (Year-End):** The system must automatically manage year-end processes, including defined carry-over limits or pay-out calculations based on the company's annual leave policy.

These requirements describe the specific actions and capabilities the system must possess:

7.2 Functional Requirements

- **User Management (P: H):** Support user authentication via company Single Sign-On (SSO) protocol (company email) and role-based access control (Employee, Manager, HR Admin).
- **Workflow (P: H):** Support flexible, multi-level approval routing based on the organizational hierarchy defined in the HRIS data feed.
- **Calendar View (P: M):** Provide a team calendar view that allows managers to easily visualize overlapping and scheduled leave for their direct reports.

- **Interface (P: M):** Offer an intuitive, web-based user interface that is compatible with current versions of Chrome, Firefox, and Edge browsers.
- **Data Import/Export (P: M):** Provide a function for HR to securely import and export employee data (name, ID, department, initial balance) via a structured CSV file.
- **Audit Trail (P: H):** Maintain a complete, immutable audit history of every leave request, including submission date, approval/rejection timestamp, and the identity of the user who performed the action.

7.3 Non-Functional Requirements

These requirements describe how the system must perform:

- **Performance:** Page load time must be less than 3 seconds when accessed by up to 50 concurrent users.
- **Security:** All data transmission must utilize current SSL/TLS encryption. Sensitive employee data must be encrypted at rest.
- **Availability:** The system must maintain 99.9% uptime during standard business hours (Monday–Friday, 8 AM – 6 PM local time).
- **Scalability:** The system architecture must be designed to support a user base of up to 5,000 employees without requiring a major re-platforming effort.
- **Disaster Recovery:** The system must have a documented recovery plan, ensuring a Recovery Time Objective (RTO) of no more than 4 hours.

7.4 Requirements Traceability Matrix

Requirement ID	Description	Priority	Supporting FRs	Supporting NFRs
BR-1	Employees must be able to submit, modify, and cancel planned leave requests online, accessible 24/7.	H	User Management, Workflow, Interface	Security, Availability
BR-2	The system must automatically calculate and display an employee's accrued, utilized, and remaining leave balance,	H	Data Import/Export	Performance, Scalability

	updated within 1 hour of any transaction.			
BR-3	The system must send an automated email notification to the manager and employee when a request is submitted, approved, or rejected, with a guaranteed delivery time of under 5 minutes.	H	Workflow	Performance, Availability
BR-4	HR administrators must be able to generate audit reports detailing all leave transactions for a specific employee or department over a selectable date range, completing the query execution within 30 seconds.	M	Data Import/Export, Audit Trail	Performance
BR-5	The system must enforce defined company policy limits, such as requiring specific supporting documentation for certain leave types.	H	Workflow	Security
BR-6	Managers must be able to view their direct reports' historical leave usage and future planned leave on a single dashboard before approving a new request.	M	Calendar View, Interface	Performance
BR-7	The system must support and differentiate between at least five distinct, configurable leave types.	M	Workflow	N/A
BR-8	The system must prevent employees from submitting leave requests that would result in a negative balance unless	H	Workflow, Audit Trail	Security

	explicitly overridden by an authorized HR administrator.			
BR-9	The system must comply with all national labor laws regarding minimum leave entitlements and maximum continuous leave duration.	H	Workflow, Audit Trail	Availability
BR-10	The system must automatically manage year-end processes, including defined carry-over limits or pay-out calculations based on the company's annual leave policy.	M	Data Import/Export	Performance

8. Assumptions and Risks

Assumption	Risk if Assumption Fails	Mitigation Strategy (for documentation)
All target employees have reliable access to a digital device and stable internet connectivity.	Low system adoption, delays in leave submission, increased HR workload to manage exceptions.	Provide dedicated access terminals at office locations for non-desk employees.
The company's official leave policies will be finalized and formally signed off by HR before the design phase begins.	Scope creep, requirement rework, and significant project delays during the development phase.	Freeze design/development until formal policy sign-off is complete.
Accurate and up-to-date employee master data will be provided by HR in a structured format for initial system setup.	Inaccurate initial leave balances, payroll errors, and delayed system launch.	Dedicated QA effort on initial data migration validation with HR sign-off on data accuracy.

HR and management will allocate time for mandatory training on the new system.	Misuse of the system, high error rates post-launch, and increased need for post-implementation support.	Make system access contingent upon completion of a mandatory 30-minute training module.
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9. Constraints

These limitations must be respected throughout the project lifecycle:

- **Budget:** The total budget for development, licensing, and initial deployment must not exceed \$50,000.
- **Timeline:** The LMS must be fully developed, tested, and ready for a pilot deployment within 4 months from the project initiation date.
- **Compliance:** The system must adhere to all applicable GDPR and local data privacy regulations regarding the collection, storage, and processing of employee personal information.
- **Technical Infrastructure:** The system must operate on existing on-premises HR servers. No external cloud infrastructure (e.g., Google Cloud Platform) or Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) solutions may be used for hosting.
- **Integration:** Integration efforts are limited to a single batch data export file for the existing payroll system; real-time integration is prohibited.

10. Sign-off

Formal approval follows a sequential workflow: **HR Head → IT Manager → Senior Management**. Approval confirms that all stakeholders have reviewed and agreed to the requirements defined in this document, authorizing the start of the design phase.

Role	Signature	Date
HR Head	_____	_____
IT Manager	_____	_____
Senior Management	_____	_____